

-
-
-
-
-

Chapter 1

Application Manager Overview



Prerequisites

You should be familiar with your display station and its controls. There are also some elements of its display and certain keys on the keyboard which are standard, regardless of the software which is currently running at the display station, or which hardware system the display is attached to. Some of these keys are:

- Cursor movement keys
- Function keys
- Field Exit keys
- Insert and Delete keys
- The Error Reset key

You should know how to operate you display station when it is attached to the server and running server software. This requires a knowledge of OS/400 and the Control Language (CL) to do such things as:

- Sign on and sign off the display station
- Interact with displays
- Use Help
- Enter control commands and procedure commands
- Call utilities
- Respond to messages
- The above information is contained in the IBM manual: System Operation: Display Station User's Guide SC21-9744. If you require further information, the following IBM manuals may be consulted:

Information Directory, GC21-9678

Licensed Program's Installation Guide, SC12-9765

System Operations: Operator's Guide, SC21-8082

System Conventions

To avoid the repetition of standard facilities and procedures, certain common routines and functions are referred to by the following conventions:

Signing Off

By entering 90 on the command line of a menu you will sign off the system and return to the initial sign on menu provided by the server's operating software.

Screen Rolling

When the number of lines to be displayed exceeds the capacity of the screen, the rolling facility is available. To execute the roll function press the Shift key and either the Roll Up or Roll Down key, or if the work station does not have Roll keys, use the Page Down or Page Up keys.

Enter Key

In conformance with IBM's SAA standards the **Enter** key is used to update the current record or move to the next screen, for example, in the case of selecting an option.



Note: In some instances where updating the record may give rise to complex consequences you may be asked to confirm the request.

Environment Code

Each software module or application belongs to a specified environment.

For example, you may wish to have a live environment and a test environment for your Financial Systems. The environment code is used to differentiate between these environments.

An application is identified using the keys:

Application ID	e.g. GL General Ledger
Environment	e.g. TST Test Environment
Release	e.g. 03 Version 3



Note: Modules are shipped with a blank environment code.

Selecting Menu Options

All menus and sub-menus used by System Manager and Developer modules enable you to:

- Enter option numbers and then press the **Enter** key
- Move the 'action bar' to the required option and press the **Enter** key. The 'action bar' can be moved by using the Roll keys
- You can go directly to menu options by entering /n. Where n is the option number. If there are sub-menus then you may enter /n/n
- The menus of other System Manager and developer modules may be accessed directly by entering /a. Where a is a single character module ID

- /a Application Manager
- /c Administration Functions
- /f File Migration Utility
- /h Housekeeping
- /i IPG/400
- /m Machine Manager
- /n Network Manager
- /r IRG/400 (Report Generator)
- /v VIEWfinder

Additional Function Key

An additional function key is available from the Application Manager menu.

F22=Select Application

Selection of this function key displays the following screen:

The screenshot displays the 'Application Manager' interface. At the top, it shows 'XA200' on the left, 'Application Manager' in the center, and 'System: STUDB30A' on the right. The 'Main Menu' is a list of options: 1. Maintain Applications, 2. Maintain Library Lists, 3. Maintain Tasks, 4. Maintain Menus, 5. Operational Enquiries, 6. Documentation, 7. Utilities, 8. Execute Application Man, and 9. Exit. Below the menu is a 'Selection or command' field with a cursor. At the bottom, there are function key assignments: F3=Exit, F4=Prom, F10=Command Entry, and F12=Pre. The 'Select Application' screen is also visible, showing a 'Position List To: _ _ _' field, a prompt 'Type option, press Enter.', and a list of applications: '1=Select Application', 'Op ID Env RI Application Text', 'IN 03 Inventory Management.', and 'GL 03 General Ledger.'. The word 'Bottom' is in the bottom right corner of the screen.

This enables you to select a particular application to process.

F8=Create Application

Select this function key to create a new application profile.

System Manager

System Manager is the generic name for the following modules:

- Application Manager
- Machine Manager
- Housekeeping
- Networking

To access System Manager enter the command:



IPGCFP4/STRM400



Note: You may wish to access System Manager when you sign on to the Server. To achieve this change your user profile so that STRM400P is the 'initial program to call'. Enter the command:



CHGUSRPRF USRPRF(uuuuuuuuuuu)INLPGM(IPGCFP4/STRM400P)

Administration Functions

The purpose of the Administration Functions is to maintain those parameters which are common across all System Manager modules.



To access Administration Functions from the Manager 400 main menu either enter 9 in the option field and press **Enter**, or use the Roll keys to move the 'action bar' so that it highlights the Administration Functions module and then press **Enter**.

XA800 Administration Functions System: STUDB30A

Administration Menu

1. Maintain User Profiles
2. Maintain Language Parameters
3. Apply Authorisation Codes
4. Maintain Company Parameters
5. Maintain Soft Options
6. Authorisation Violation Log
7. Exit

Selection or command
==>

F3=Exit F4=Prompt F6=Messages F9=Retrieve
F10=Command Entry F12=Previous F14=View Jobs F24=More Keys

The Administration Functions module of System Manager is a prerequisite for the installation of IPG/400, all other modules within System Manager and the Developer products.



Note: Access to Administration Functions is restricted and is controlled by your System Manager user profile. If you are unable to access Administration Functions contact your server security officer. When shipped, System Manager is set up to allow access to the system security officer (QSECOFR).

The following system-wide parameters can be set up and maintained within Administration Functions.

- Language Parameters - In System Manager, users who speak different languages can each use the same server with display screen constants and messages shown in their native language. This option maintains language descriptions for all the language options which exist in the system.
- Company Parameters - When running application software or your own software you may wish to use a multi-company environment. The Company Parameters option is where company details are set up and maintained.

- Soft Options - Many users have a set of jobs or activities which they want to carry out routinely on the server. Soft options enable you to set up those jobs or activities and run them from anywhere within the System Manager environment.

Application Manager

The Application Manager module provides advanced system integration and easy creation and maintenance of security-conscious menu systems.

For users of standard applications, the product is provided in a ready-to-use state. When the supplied version is loaded it will already be aware of the applications which it has been designed to support.

Application Manager enables you to:

- Interchange between application areas more easily
- Create free-format user-defined menus
- Provide password protection at menu option level
- Provide password protection at function level
- Display current system processing, i.e. which terminal is processing which function
- Add tailor-made functions to user-defined menus
- Work in 'expert mode' of menu operation
- Control job queues and print queues for submitted jobs
- Provide 'exclusive-use-needed' control over applications
- Provide control of the multi-language environment for all standard applications

Application Manager makes it easy to move from one module to another; not only can it provide, on a single menu, a series of options regardless of the module to which they belong, but it can also be used to restrict access at company (for multi-company products), module, menu and menu option level. Application Manager achieves this by providing a simple method of tailor-made menu generation.



Note: Since details from the user profile are used within other System Manager modules, maintenance of user profiles is carried out from the Administration Functions module. Reference to the user profile is made where it is relevant to the Application Manager module.

Menus

Application integration is achieved via the generation of tailor-made menus. Application Manager provides total flexibility in its approach to the building of menus, and thus provides a choice as to the accessibility and content of the user menu.

The user has total flexibility in the layout of his/her menu. Most field-level display attributes may be used (for example, highlighting, underlining, and colour), and the menus are in no way pre-structured as, for example, in two columns. Therefore the user has total freedom to lay out the menu display exactly as he/she wishes.

The use of function keys is totally soft-coded, and may be associated with any action which is required.

Access Control

The accessibility feature controls which companies (for multi-company environments), which applications, and which functions within applications to which a user is granted access. Menu content may be restricted to those functions to which the user is authorised. Access to functions for which the user has not been granted rights of usage will be inhibited at execution time.

This is achieved in two stages:

- At user level, by selecting the menus and menu activities to which the user is authorised.
- At application level, by selecting specific tasks from an application to which the user is allowed access, and within which companies. For example, the user's profile may be set up to enable access to all enquiry menus and all enquiry tasks in a selected application.

Tasks

Each activity which can be carried out under the control of Application Manager is defined as being a task. This describes, for example, which program should be called to perform this activity and whether it is a batch (submitted) or an interactive task. An application may be thought of as a set of tasks, logically grouped together - Accounts Receivable, for example, or Sales Order Processing. To use an entire application, you need to be authorised to all the tasks for that application.

A single menu can feature tasks from many different applications and can thus provide a seamless user environment.

User Profile

In addition to the server user profile, each user has a System Manager user profile for Application Manager. This controls:

- The default sign-on menu to be used.
- The default company assigned (where a multi-company environment is active).
- The default job and print queues. These may be overridden at company and task level. For example, you may wish to have invoices printed on a dedicated printer.
- Whether the user is authorised to enter commands.
- Whether an alternative language is to be used.

In addition, user authorisation to other menus can be granted and authority to application-defined tasks and the companies within applications can be given.

Library Lists

Library lists are set up within the system by reference to a set of standard library list files which are supplied with the system. These library lists are set up to cater for all standard usages of the applications, but you can change them to allow for tailor-made modifications to your own applications. Each application has its own set of library lists. Library lists may be set up to cater for test or training environments where impact on the live data must be eliminated.

Application Profile

Each application must have its own application profile, defining which version of the application is in use and the name of that application. The application profile specifies the default library list to be used, and whether or not a specific application day-end program is required.

Management & Control

Application Manager provides automatic error logging. In the event of an error the system displays a user-friendly message, informing you of an abnormal termination. The system also writes an error record to a file you can enquire on to determine the cause of the error. The error file may also be printed and the results sent to the software support organisation if necessary.

Application Manager enables you to allocate any or all applications for exclusive use, for example for copying files to off-line storage. The system will notify you if anyone is using the application, and permit the sending of a user-defined message to any or all users notifying them of the need for exclusive use of the system. Any user attempting to sign on to an allocated application will receive a message to the effect that the application is not available, and will be unable to access any functions within the application.

Advanced Menu Functions

In addition to providing menus from which the user may enter options or select function keys, you are also able to:

- Use menus in expert mode - If an application has a hierarchical menu structure you may simply enter the name of a menu in the menu option field to go directly to that menu rather than by selecting options from a series of menus to reach the desired menu. In addition, if you know the specific option number required from the menu you can enter this together with the menu name to directly access the task required.
- If you do not know how to access a required task by menu navigation then a search facility is available. This enables you to enter a word contained within the description of the task. A list of tasks which contain the specified word (which you are authorised to) is then displayed, and you may select one of the tasks to process.
- In addition to exact word matches when searching for tasks you are able to set up synonyms to reflect your business. For example, you may wish to have the word 'Item' associated with the words 'Part', 'Product', and 'Assembly'. Once you have set up your own synonyms the task searching facility is used as described above and is transparent to the user.

To access Application Manager enter '4' in the option field and press **Enter**, or use the Roll keys to move the 'action bar' so that Application Manager is highlighted and press **Enter**.

The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'Application Manager' with 'XA200' on the left and 'System: STUDB30A' on the right. A 'Main Menu' box is centered, containing a list of options: 1. Maintain Applications, 2. Maintain Library Lists, 3. Maintain Tasks, 4. Maintain Menus, 5. Operational Enquiries, 6. Documentation, 7. Utilities, 8. Execute Application Manager, and 9. Exit. Below the menu box is a 'Selection or command' prompt with an arrow pointing to a line. At the bottom, there are four columns of function key definitions: F3=Exit, F10=Command Entry, F4=Browse, F12=Previous, F6=Messages, F14=View Jobs, F9=Retrieve, and F24=More Keys.

```
XA200                               Application Manager                               System: STUDB30A

Main Menu
1. Maintain Applications
2. Maintain Library Lists
3. Maintain Tasks
4. Maintain Menus
5. Operational Enquiries
6. Documentation
7. Utilities
8. Execute Application Manager
9. Exit

Selection or command
=> _____

F3=Exit      F4=Browse    F6=Messages  F9=Retrieve
F10=Command Entry  F12=Previous F14=View Jobs F24=More Keys
```